Lesson plan · for the teacher

Spot a phishing message

Cyber safety · Level 1 · Lesson 2

Time
40 min

Materials
Board and chalk (or paper on the wall); 6 handwritten or printed message cards per group; Worksheet: Scam detective (one per pair, optional)

Learning goals

- Name five warning signs of a scam message.
- Sort printed messages into “scam” and “safe” and point to the warning sign.
- Explain how to check a message another way, such as asking a trusted adult.

Activity: Scam or safe?: Scam sort

1. Warm-up (5 min): Tell the gate story: a stranger says, “The head teacher sent me for the exam papers.” Ask pupils what they would do.
2. Teach (8 min): Explain phishing: a message that pretends to be someone you trust. Write the five warning signs on the board, each with a small drawing: clock, link, mask, key, gift.
3. Scam sort (14 min): Groups get six message cards. They sort them into “scam” and “safe” piles and write the warning sign on each scam card. Walk around and ask groups to explain one choice.
4. Share (7 min): Each group reads one scam card aloud and says what they would do: stop, tell a trusted adult, check another way, then report and delete.
5. Wrap-up (6 min): Exit ticket: each pupil writes one warning sign and one safe action. Collect a few and read them out.

Write six short messages on cards, three scams and three safe. Scams: a prize, an urgent fee, a request for a code. Safe: a timetable, a sports reminder, a library notice. Make one set per group.

Discussion

- Would you hand over the exam papers?
- How could you check whether the story is true?
- Which warning sign do you see?

Exit ticket

- One warning sign + what I would do if I saw it.

Try it in class tomorrow
Play “Scam or safe?”: Write six short messages on paper — three scams, three safe: a prize, a code request, an urgent fee, a timetable, a sports reminder, a library notice. Read each aloud. Pupils stand for “scam”, sit for “safe”, and name the warning sign.

Worksheet · for pupils

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **Which of these are warning signs of phishing?**

- [ ] "Reply within 24 hours or lose your account"
- [ ] A link you weren't expecting
- [ ] Tomorrow's timetable from the school's saved number
- [ ] A request for your mobile money PIN
- [ ] A message that greets you by name

2 **Scam messages are always full of spelling mistakes.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

3 **You tapped a link in a fake message and typed your email password. Put what to do next in order.**

- [ ] Change your email password right away
- [ ] Report the message, then delete it
- [ ] Close the page and type nothing more
- [ ] Change it anywhere else you used it

4 **A "colleague" texts from a new number: "My phone broke. Send me money by mobile money now — I'll pay you back tomorrow." What is the best first step?**

- ◯ Reply and ask, "Is this really you?"
- ◯ Call your colleague on the number you already have
- ◯ Send it — they promised to pay it back

5 **Match each message to its warning sign.**

"Act now or lose your place"	• • • •	Asks for a code
"Read me the code we just sent"	• • • •	Sender doesn't match
"You've won a laptop!"	• • • •	Urgency or a threat
A "bank" on a personal number	• • • •	Too good to be true

Answers · for the teacher

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1 **"Reply within 24 hours or lose your account"; A link you weren't expecting; A request for your mobile money PIN**

The 24-hour threat is meant to rush you past checking, a link you weren't expecting can open a fake page that steals your password, and no real company needs your PIN.

2 **False**

Many scams are well written and copy real logos.

3 **Top to bottom: 2, 4, 1, 3**

Stop the damage, lock your account, then close other doors.

4 **Call your colleague on the number you already have**

Calling the number you already have checks through another channel: a scammer on a new number can't answer your colleague's real phone.

5 **"Act now or lose your place" — Urgency or a threat**
"Read me the code we just sent" — Asks for a code
"You've won a laptop!" — Too good to be true
A "bank" on a personal number — Sender doesn't match

Naming the sign helps you slow down — and helps pupils explain why a message is a scam.

For you to think about

Think of a scam message you, a colleague or a parent has received. Which warning sign gave it away — or would have?